ISO 20400 Sustainable procurement (guidance)

Service information sheet. Sustainability and Supply Chain. Information checked 11 October 2026.

In brief

ISO 20400 is the international guidance standard for sustainable procurement. It helps organisations build environmental, social and economic considerations into how they buy. It is not certifiable; ICFC assesses your alignment and helps you put it into practice.

What it is

ISO 20400 gives guidance on integrating sustainability into procurement policy, strategy and processes.

Who it is for

Procurement teams, public sector suppliers and organisations managing supplier sustainability risk.

How ICFC helps

Service	What we offer
Audit	No certification: ISO 20400 is a guidance document and is not intended for certification. Alignment assessment: First-party and second-party assessments that score how well your practices align with the guidance, with a practical gap report. Supplier checks: Second-party reviews of suppliers or partners against the guidance where your customers expect it.
Consulting	Funding: We explain which scheme, if any, applies and what it requires before you commit. Non-grant: A fixed-scope engagement: gap assessment, documentation, implementation coaching, internal audit and management review, and support through the formal audit or assessment. How we work: Practical, proportionate systems that your staff can run after we leave.
Training	Classroom: Public and in-house classroom courses on ISO 20400: awareness, implementation and internal auditor levels. Online LMS: Self-paced and live-online courses on the ICFC Digital LMS, with progress tracking and certificates of completion. Funding: Funding depends on each course's approval status, shown on the course page in the LMS.

Funding

Not on the EDGE Standards list. We did not find this standard on the EDGE Standards list when we checked. Ask us about non-grant options or other schemes that may apply.

Impartiality

Impartiality comes first. Every engagement begins with a conflict-of-interest check. We keep consulting and auditing roles separate, and our auditors never audit, on behalf of a certification body, an organisation that ICFC has consulted on the same scope within the period set by that body.

Frequently asked questions

Q. Can we be certified to ISO 20400?
A. No. It is guidance. We provide alignment assessments and implementation support.

Q. Where should we start?
A. With a spend analysis to find the categories with the highest sustainability risk and opportunity.

Q. Does it link to supplier audits?
A. Yes. Our second-party supplier audits put the guidance into action.

Q. Does it help with sustainability reporting?
A. Yes. Supply chain data feeds into reporting on value chain impacts.

Related services

- ISO 26000 Guidance on social responsibility
- ISO 20121 Event sustainability management system

- Worldwide Responsible Accredited Production (WRAP)
- Sustainability reporting assessment (training only)

Talk to us

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